DINNER · POPPY'S KITCHEN

Chicken & Eggplant Parm



Crispy panko chicken and eggplant, Rao's, bubbling mozzarella. The oven does the frying.

4, plus a lunch	55 min
SERVES	START TO TABLE
25 min	**30 min**
PREP	COOK

Worth-it weeknight

🛒 What you need

FROM THE STORE

- ▢ **1½ lb** Chicken breasts or cutlets
- ▢ **1 large** Eggplant
- ▢ **2** Eggs
- ▢ **2 cups** Panko bread crumbs
- ▢ **½ cup** Grated parmesan
- ▢ **1 jar (24 oz)** Rao's marinara
- ▢ **2 cups** Tillamook mozzarella, shredded

FROM THE PANTRY

- ▢ **½ cup** Flour
- ▢ Olive oil or cooking spray
- ▢ Salt, pepper, garlic powder, dried oregano
- ▢ **optional** Pasta to serve

⚡ **First:** Oven to 425°F and salt the eggplant first.

GEAR

2 sheet pans + foil · 3 shallow plates · Meat thermometer

🔥 Let's cook

1. Oven to 425°F. Line 2 sheet pans with foil and oil them well.
2. Slice the eggplant into ½-inch rounds; salt and set aside 10 minutes. If the chicken breasts are thick, slice them in half the long way. ⏱️ 10 min
3. Set up three plates: flour; eggs beaten with a splash of water; panko mixed with half the parmesan, oregano, garlic powder, salt. 🧒 Kids can do this
4. Dredge chicken and patted-dry eggplant: flour, egg, panko. Lay on the pans and spray or drizzle the tops with oil. 🧒 Kids can do this
5. Bake until golden, flipping once. ⏱️ 20 min
6. Spoon sauce over each piece, top with mozzarella and parmesan, and bake until bubbly. 🧒 Kids can do this ⏱️ 8–10 min
7. Warm the rest of the sauce for pasta, if serving.



CHEF'S SECRET

Salt the eggplant and pat it dry before breading. It pulls out bitterness and water, so it bakes up crisp instead of soggy.

Poppy's draft. Change something? Tell Poppy with 💡 so the card learns.



DINNER · FLIP SIDE

Chicken & Eggplant Parm

👩‍🍳 Kitchen crew: kid jobs

- ☐ Set up the breading station
- ☐ Bread the eggplant (dry hand, wet hand)
- ☐ Spoon on the sauce and cheese
- ☐ Cook the pasta with a grown-up

Knives, the stove and the oven: a grown-up stays right there. Steps marked 🧒 **Kids can do this** on the front are theirs to own.

⏰ MAKE IT AHEAD

Bread everything in the morning and refrigerate on the pans; bake when you get home.

🥡 LEFTOVERS

Parm sandwiches on a demi baguette or bolillo roll for lunch.

🔁 SWAP IT

- WF chicken scallopini (i384) skips the slicing
- Just chicken or just eggplant

🍽️ SERVE IT WITH

Spaghetti or fusilli, and a simple salad

⏱️ Game plan: everything lands at once

55 min out	Oven to 425°F. Salt the eggplant; split the chicken.
45 min	Kids set up flour, egg and panko plates.
40 min	Bread chicken and eggplant; onto the oiled pans.
35 min	Into the oven; flip halfway.
12 min	Sauce and cheese on top; back in to bubble.
Dinner	Serve with the extra warm sauce.

Done cooking? Tell Poppy how it went.

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